

2: Phonology

2.1: Vowel System

There are 10 vowel phonemes in Journalist. Each vowel has a paired partner which is considered either tense or lax. In the diagram, paired vowels show the tense vowels on the left, lax on the right. Both central vowels are lax.

	front	central	back
close	i, ɪ		u
mid	e, ɛ	ʌ	o, ɔ
open	æ	a	

In traditional Adinjo material, tense vowels may be marked with an *asènt dai* or acute accent, while lax vowels may be marked with a *blut dai* or grave accent. In normal orthography these marks also control word stress, so this grammar will use the circumflex to mark tense and the breve to mark lax when it is otherwise following natural stress.

In addition to the above, leading post-consonantal <o> and <i> may trigger labialization and palatalization (respectively) if they are part of a diphthong, while <e> in such positions will often cause the following vowel to fricativize into a consonant.

Vowels generally form diphthongs when they come in contact with each other. When they do not, the Adin convention is to separate them with an *apsotrophe*.

2.2: Consonantal System

There are 32 consonant phonemes in Journalist. These are given in the following table:

	Fron t	Alveodenta l	Alveola r	Post-Alveola r	Palata l	Vela r	Glotta l
Nasal	m		n		ɲ	ŋ	
Plosive	p b		t d			k g	ʔ
Fricative	f v	θ ð	s z	ʃ ʒ		x	h
Affricate			ts dz	tʃ dʒ			
Lateral		l					
Approximan t			ɹ		j		

	Front t	Alveodental l	Alveolar r	Post-Alveolar r	Palatal l	Velar r	Glottal l
Other		<u>mn</u>	<u>tl</u> r			w	

It is worth noting that /ŋ/ is the only consonant which is not attested to be able to begin a word or syllable, similarly to English. All other consonants can occur in syllable-initial and syllable-final positions.

2.3: Stress

While stress can be explicitly marked in Adinjo, this is considered *unnatural* stress. Natural Stress can be calculated in Adinjo by using archiphonemes //I, U, E, O//, only in words which have no *tense* vowel marks.

By default, unnatural stress take precedence over natural stress. Thus, if you see any *asent dai* or acute accents in a word, the earliest one takes primary stress and any later *asentu* take secondary.

2.3.1 Primary Stress

In words with natural stress, you must scan the word for the earliest occurrence of the closest and frontmost vowels. For this purpose, //I// represents both <i, ì>, with each other archiphonemic vowel representing its lowercase forms. If there is no //I//, proceed through the list seeking //U, E, O// in that order. This includes diphthongs

For example, in the word *adin* 'everybody' the primary stress falls on the second syllable: /a.dîn/. In *niejin* 'prayer' the primary stress falls on the second //I// or the second syllable: /ne.ʒîn/.

2.4: Intonation

Describe the intonation patterns of the language. This usually involves rising and falling pitch or tone across utterances. Be sure to cover the intonation patterns of different types of statements.

2.5: Phonotactics & Morphophonemics

What are the phonological constraints of syllables and words in LANGNAME? Are they always open, or may they sometimes be closed? Is there a tendency or preference towards open syllables? Are consonant clusters allowed freely, or in restricted circumstances? Do words borrowed from other languages get to violate these rules? Are there any special cases for word-initial or word-final structures that aren't allowed elsewhere?

What about phonological processes? Is there any form of assimilation, fortition, lenition, or other mutations? Do these cross syllable boundaries? Word

boundaries? Are these processes generally progressive (affecting later sounds) or regressive (affecting earlier sounds)?

2.6: Orthography

How is LANGNAME written? Does it have its own script, or does it borrow a script from another language or culture? What additions or subtractions (if any), does it make if borrowing a script? How are any irregularities noted in this orthography? Does it mark phonemic variation in general, or in specific dialects?

2.6.1: Romanization*

If LANGNAME has its own script, it may be worth also exploring a romanized* orthography for the purposes of the grammar documentation, or people who cannot read the native script.